# A Pattern I Believe Canada Can No Longer Ignore

An Investigative Reflection on Governance, Democratic Erosion, and the Case for Constitutional Convention

A Citizen's Account | 2025

*This document represents protected speech under freedom of expression. It contains allegations, concerns, and interpretations about state conduct and institutional failure. It is not a criminal indictment, not legal advice, and not a call to violence.*

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## Preface: Why I Am Writing This

I write this as a Canadian who believes the country has crossed a line.

Not in one dramatic instant. Not in one single scandal. Not in one single statute. But through a pattern. A long pattern. A pattern of concentration of power, moralized messaging, elite impunity, administrative expansion, selective accountability, and increasingly direct state involvement in the most intimate areas of human life: speech, mobility, finance, medicine, bodily autonomy, and death.

I am not asking anyone to accept my conclusions automatically. I am asking a more difficult question: when the same direction of travel keeps repeating itself from 2015 onward, at what point does "misgovernment" stop being an adequate description?

From my perspective, Canada now requires an immediate constitutional convention, a fully independent public reckoning, and international scrutiny of whether its governing culture still conforms to democratic and human-rights norms.

### Content Note

This is a political opinion piece written from my perspective as a Canadian citizen. It contains allegations, concerns, and interpretations about state conduct, institutional failure, and human-rights risk. It is not a criminal indictment, not legal advice, and not a call to violence. Readers should use discernment and compare every claim against the public record.

What follows is protected speech under freedom of expression. I raise questions. I expose patterns. I do not draw conclusions for you. I present what I have observed, what I have researched, and what I believe the evidence suggests. The reader is invited to reach their own conclusions.

## Why I See a Pattern Rather Than Isolated Events

A free society can survive bad decisions. What it cannot survive indefinitely is a governing pattern in which every crisis expands authority, every scandal dissipates

upward, every safeguard bends toward administrative convenience, and every dissenting voice is told that the problem is not the state but the citizen who objects.

That is the pattern I see.

Cause and effect.

Power centralizes. Oversight weakens. Public trust erodes. The state answers the resulting distrust with more management, more regulation, more narrative discipline, more expert mediation, and less tolerance for fundamental dissent.

By the end of that cycle, the institutions still exist on paper, but the public increasingly experiences them not as protectors, but as instruments of controlled compliance.

I want to be precise about what I mean by "pattern." I do not mean a conspiracy. I do not mean a secret agreement among officials. I mean something more observable and, in some ways, more troubling: a repeated structural response to political pressure that produces the same kind of outcome regardless of which particular official happens to be in office at the time.

When I look at Canada since 2015, I see the following structural pattern recur:

0. First, a moral or political emergency is declared or acknowledged by the state.
1. Second, extraordinary measures are proposed and normalized through legislation, regulation, or administrative directive.
2. Third, oversight mechanisms eventually issue criticism, but consequences remain narrow or symbolic.
3. Fourth, the administrative state absorbs the criticism, makes minor adjustments, and continues on the same trajectory.
4. Fifth, the public is told the system worked because a report was written or a review was conducted.

This pattern appears in ethics enforcement. It appears in emergency governance. It appears in foreign-interference response. It appears in the MAID system's expansion despite persistent disability-rights alarm. And every time the cycle repeats, the same

effect follows: citizens are expected to accept less direct control over public life while being told this is what responsible governance now looks like.

## 2015 to 2016: The Moral Architecture Begins to Shift

### MAID in Context

In 2016, Parliament enacted the federal legal framework for Medical Assistance in Dying (MAID) following the Supreme Court's 2015 Carter ruling. This made the state a lawful participant in the deliberate ending of eligible patients' lives. Health Canada's current framework still describes MAID as an exception to criminal prohibitions on ending a human life, with mandatory reporting intended to support transparency and public trust.

I want to be clear about my position here. I am not arguing that every individual MAID provision was wrongful. I am not second-guessing the private medical decisions made between patients and practitioners in genuinely unbearable circumstances. What concerns me is the systemic framework and the direction in which it has traveled.

That matters to me because laws do more than regulate conduct. They teach the country what it is willing to call compassionate, rational, and normal. Once the state crosses from prohibiting intentional killing to regulating it, a moral threshold has been crossed. The burden of proof on the state should become extreme. The oversight should be relentless. The scrutiny should deepen, not soften.

Instead, the system has expanded.

### The Numbers

Health Canada's 2024 annual report states that 16,499 people received MAID in 2024 alone, bringing the cumulative total since legalization in 2016 to 76,475 by the end of 2024. The same report indicates that 95.6% of respondents to the race question identified as White/Caucasian, that 32.9% of respondents identified as having a disability, and that 4.4% of 2024 MAID provisions were Track 2 cases, where natural death was not reasonably foreseeable.

I am not making a criminal accusation with those numbers. I am asking what they reveal about the direction of the state.

If a government builds, funds, trains, and normalizes a system that increasingly channels suffering people into a legally managed death pathway, then the public has the right to ask whether that framework is still anchored first in the protection of life, or whether it has begun to reorder priorities around administrative efficiency, autonomy rhetoric, and system pressure.

Seventy-six thousand lives ended through state-sanctioned medical assistance in less than a decade. That is not a marginal policy. That is a fundamental transformation of the state's relationship to human life and death.

## The Disability Rights Question Is No Longer Fringe

This is not just my concern.

In March 2025, the UN Committee on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities expressed concern during Canada's review about MAID as it applies to persons with disabilities, especially where social suffering and unmet needs may drive requests. An OHCHR summary of the proceedings records that the legal framework surrounding MAID was a major issue in the dialogue and that Canada said it had ongoing engagement with disability communities because of concerns that vulnerable persons with disabilities who were not at imminent risk of death might seek MAID when their suffering stemmed from unmet needs.

Health Canada's own materials say monitoring exists to identify "forms of inequality and disadvantage that may be present." That line is revealing. If the federal government itself acknowledges the need to monitor inequality and disadvantage within MAID, then the public is not irrational for asking whether those inequalities are peripheral, or whether they go to the moral core of the whole framework.

Eligibility for MAID where mental illness is the sole underlying condition has been delayed again, now until March 17, 2027. I do not find that reassuring. I find it indicative of a system that knows it is moving faster than its own ethical foundations can support.

My point is not that I can definitively prove the worst conclusion. My point is that a civilized country should not need citizens to beg for a deeper investigation when such questions are already sitting in the open.

When the United Nations disability rights body is raising alarms about your country's death-assistance framework, and your own government acknowledges the need to monitor for inequality within that framework, the question is no longer whether there is a problem. The question is whether the political will exists to face it.

## 2017 Onward: Ethics Findings and the Normalization of Elite Impunity

A country's constitutional health is measured not only by laws, but by consequences.

### The Aga Khan Report (2017)

In 2017, the Conflict of Interest and Ethics Commissioner found that Prime Minister Trudeau contravened the Conflict of Interest Act in what became known as the Aga Khan report. The Commissioner determined that the Prime Minister had accepted gifts and hospitality that he should have known were likely to influence his decisions.

This was not a minor technicality. This was the country's top ethics watchdog finding that the head of government had broken the rules designed to prevent the exact kind of private-influence-over-public-office that democratic systems are built to resist.

### The SNC-Lavalin Report (2019)

In 2019, the Commissioner's Trudeau II Report found that Trudeau contravened section 9 of the Act in the SNC-Lavalin matter by using his position to seek to influence the Attorney General's decision in relation to a criminal prosecution.

Consider what that means. The Prime Minister of Canada was found by the official ethics watchdog to have used his office to pressure the Attorney General — the country's top law officer — regarding a criminal case involving a major Quebec-based corporation with deep Liberal Party ties.

That matters because scandal alone does not define a regime. The public reaction to scandal does.

When heads of government are found by the official ethics watchdog to have broken conflict rules, and yet the larger political machine survives with limited structural consequence, the public learns something. It learns that legality, accountability, and consequences may not operate upward the way they operate downward.

Cause and effect again.

Cause: repeated ethics breaches at the highest level.

Effect: public cynicism deepens, standards collapse, and each subsequent violation becomes easier to absorb as background noise.

That is how institutional rot becomes culture.

I am not suggesting these findings were ignored by the media or unknown to the public. What I am suggesting is that the political system demonstrated it could absorb findings of this gravity and continue functioning without fundamental reform. The public watched an ethics commissioner find the Prime Minister in violation of ethics law — twice — and saw the system absorb the blow and move on. That is a pattern of institutional resilience that benefits the powerful at the expense of public trust.

## 2019 to 2025: Foreign Interference and Democratic Vulnerability

I do not need to imagine foreign-interest pressure in the abstract. Canada established a full public inquiry into foreign interference, and the findings demand serious attention from anyone concerned with democratic integrity.

### The Hogue Commission Findings

Commissioner Marie-Josee Hogue's final report concluded that foreign interference is real, persistent, and directed at Canada's democratic institutions. The Commission

also found the government's response "far from perfect" and said the government had sometimes taken too long to act.

At the same time, the Commission did not find evidence that parliamentarians were "traitors," and it did not conclude that the 2019 or 2021 general election results were altered by foreign interference. I note that distinction carefully because I do not need to overstate the official findings to make the constitutional point.

The official findings are serious enough on their own terms. Foreign states sought to interfere. Canada's institutions were targeted. The response was imperfect and at times delayed. Public communication was inadequate. Disinformation and transnational repression were identified as major concerns.

## What the Response Reveals

From my perspective, that is already enough to raise a profound question: if democratic institutions are vulnerable to foreign pressure and domestic responses have been partial, delayed, or opaque, what exactly is the public being asked to trust?

I am not a counterintelligence expert. I do not have access to classified assessments. But as a citizen, I can observe the gap between the gravity of the threat and the adequacy of the response. I can note that a government which speaks frequently about protecting democracy internationally did not demonstrate the same urgency in protecting its own democratic institutions at home.

The pattern, again: a problem is acknowledged, measures are announced, critics are reassured, and the underlying vulnerability persists.

Foreign interference is not merely an espionage story. It is a constitutional story. It is a story about whether the democratic system is robust enough to recognize threats to itself and act with the speed and transparency that self-preservation requires. When the answer appears to be "not always," citizens have the right to ask what other vulnerabilities remain unaddressed.

# 2022: The Emergencies Act and the Lesson Taught to the Public

The invocation of the Emergencies Act was one of the clearest constitutional stress tests of the last decade.

## The Public Order Emergency Commission

The Public Order Emergency Commission later released a massive record-based report after examining more than 85,000 documents, interviewing 139 individuals, hearing 76 witnesses, and receiving evidence from 50 experts. Commissioner Rouleau concluded that the legality of the declaration ultimately belonged to the courts, while his commission examined the basis for invocation and the appropriateness of the measures.

The Commission's work was extensive and, by many accounts, thorough. But the judicial aftermath tells a different part of the story.

## The Judicial Aftermath

In 2024, the federal government itself acknowledged in Justice Department Q&A materials that it had lost the judicial review in Federal Court and was appealing that ruling.

That should have shaken the country harder than it did.

Because the question is not only whether one agrees or disagrees with the convoy, or with the government, or with the atmosphere of the time. The deeper issue is what precedent gets planted in the constitutional soil when emergency powers, financial controls, and extraordinary police tools are used against a domestic protest movement and later found by a court to have been wrongly invoked, even as the state continues to defend the decision on appeal.

Cause: the state reaches for exceptional powers in a domestic political crisis.

Effect: the public learns that rights may remain intact only until the political temperature rises enough.

That is not a small lesson. That is a regime-defining lesson.

I want to emphasize what concerns me most here. It is not the particular politics of the convoy or the response. It is the structural precedent. Canada has now demonstrated that its government can invoke emergency powers against a domestic protest, freeze the financial assets of participants, deploy extraordinary police measures, and then defend the decision even after a federal court has found it unlawful.

Future governments of any party now have that precedent in their toolkit. That is what constitutional erosion looks like: not the abolition of rights, but the incremental normalization of exceptions that swallow the rule.

## The Shape of the Pattern

When I stand back from these events, I do not see isolated controversies. I see an identifiable governing logic that has repeated across multiple domains and multiple years.

The pattern is structural. It operates regardless of which particular minister holds which particular portfolio. It persists because the incentives of the system reward expansion of administrative power and absorb or deflect criticism that would, in a healthier constitutional culture, produce fundamental correction.

Let me be explicit about what I observe:

In ethics enforcement: findings are made, headlines are generated, and the political system demonstrates its capacity to survive without structural reform. The public learns that accountability at the top is optional.

In emergency governance: exceptional powers are invoked, judicial review finds problems, and the government appeals while continuing to defend the original decision. The public learns that rights are contingent on political convenience.

In foreign interference: threats are acknowledged, responses are delayed, and the gap between the gravity of the problem and the adequacy of the solution remains visible. The public learns that democratic security is not always treated with the urgency it deserves.

In the MAID framework: the system expands year by year, disability rights bodies raise alarms, the government acknowledges the need to monitor for inequality within the system, and yet the expansion continues. The public learns that the state is increasingly willing to manage death as a solution to suffering that might, in a better-resourced society, be addressed through support, care, and material relief.

And every time the cycle repeats, the same effect follows: citizens are expected to accept less direct control over public life while being told this is what responsible governance now looks like.

I am not describing a conspiracy. I am describing a system of incentives that produces predictable outcomes. When power centralizes, when oversight weakens, when consequences for the powerful become symbolic, the pattern is not an aberration. It is the natural behavior of the system as currently constructed.

## Why I Believe This Raises an International Human Rights Question

I am deliberately not using the most explosive legal labels here. I do not need them to make the point.

My concern is simpler and, in some ways, more serious: does Canada still align with the human-rights norms it publicly claims to defend?

A state committed to human dignity should not lightly normalize systems that may channel socially abandoned, medically burdened, disabled, elderly, or economically pressured people toward death while claiming neutrality. A state committed to democratic legitimacy should not respond slowly to foreign interference, exercise emergency powers that later fail in court, and then ask the public to treat each breach of trust as unrelated to the next. A state committed to constitutional order should not repeatedly survive ethics findings against its top officeholders without much deeper structural consequence.

That is the alignment question as I see it.

Not whether every official is corrupt. Not whether every institution is broken. But whether the pattern of governance remains meaningfully consistent with the values it invokes.

Canada has built an international reputation as a defender of human rights, a champion of multiculturalism, and a model of constitutional stability. That reputation is not merely decorative. It is functional. It affords Canada moral authority in international forums, influence in human rights institutions, and the benefit of the doubt when questions arise about its own conduct.

I believe that reputation is now being maintained by inertia rather than by evidence. The gap between Canada's self-presentation and its governing reality has widened. The international community has every reason to examine that gap with the same scrutiny Canada applies to other nations.

The UN Committee on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities has already begun that examination. The Federal Court's ruling on the Emergencies Act contributes to it. The Hogue Commission's findings on foreign interference add to it. The repeated ethics findings against the Prime Minister document it.

Taken together, these are not isolated incidents. They are data points in a larger pattern that raises legitimate questions about whether Canada's governance culture still meets the standard it claims to uphold.

## Why I Believe Constitutional Convention Is Now Justified

Elections alone do not necessarily solve constitutional decay.

If the problem is systemic rather than partisan, then alternating parties through the same machinery may simply rotate managers through a structure that no longer commands public trust.

That is why I believe constitutional convention should now be openly discussed. Not as a slogan. As a civic necessity.

## The Four Questions

A constitutional convention, in my view, would be justified to address at least four fundamental questions:

5. Whether emergency powers and financial-control tools are adequately constrained. The Emergencies Act experience demonstrates that the current framework allows invocation against domestic protest movements, and that judicial review may not provide timely enough protection. The public deserves structural guarantees that emergency powers cannot be used as a political management tool.

6. Whether ethics enforcement and consequences for top officeholders are remotely sufficient. Two ethics findings against a sitting Prime Minister, with limited structural consequence, suggests that the current framework is inadequate. The public deserves a system in which ethics findings at the highest level trigger meaningful accountability.

7. Whether democratic safeguards against foreign interference and narrative manipulation are credible. The Hogue Commission found real, persistent interference and imperfect response. The public deserves to know that its democratic institutions are actively defended, not merely reviewed after the fact.

8. Whether the legal and oversight framework around MAID meets the standard of a country genuinely committed to equal protection for vulnerable persons. When 76,000 people have received state-sanctioned death assistance in less than a decade, when disability rights bodies raise alarms, and when the government itself monitors for inequality within the system, the public deserves a fundamental reassessment of whether the framework's trajectory aligns with human dignity.

Those are constitutional questions, not merely policy questions. They go to the architecture of power, the structure of accountability, and the relationship between the state and the citizen.

A constitutional convention would not answer these questions immediately. But it would create a forum in which they could be addressed with the seriousness they

deserve, outside the constraints of ordinary partisan politics, with the participation of citizens who are not merely voters but stakeholders in the constitutional order.

## My Conclusion, Stated Carefully

From my perspective, Canada since 2015 shows a coherent pattern of democratic erosion: elite impunity, delayed accountability, emergency normalization, foreign-interference vulnerability, and a state-sanctioned death framework expanding under ongoing ethical dispute.

I am not asking the reader to accept criminal labels. I am asking the reader to examine whether the cumulative pattern still fits the description of a healthy constitutional democracy.

I believe that question is now urgent.

I believe it is reasonable to demand immediate constitutional convention.

I believe it is reasonable to demand independent inquiry wherever oversight has been partial, compromised, or politically absorbed.

And I believe the international community has every reason to pay close attention to what Canada has become in practice, not merely what it continues to call itself in theory.

I write this not because I hate my country. I write it because I believe my country is capable of better, and because the first step toward better is honest acknowledgment of what has gone wrong.

The pattern is visible. The questions are legitimate. The need for constitutional convention is, in my view, undeniable.

What remains is whether enough citizens, enough institutions, and enough members of the international community are willing to look at the pattern and demand that it be addressed before it becomes irreversible.

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# A Citizen's Account

*"The first step toward better is honest acknowledgment of what has gone wrong."*

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